

Chapter

The Power of the Deities in Your Life — Creation, Preservation and Dissolution



Introduction: Three Gods, Three Goddesses

We have all heard of Brahma, Vishnu and Mahesh since childhood. But are they only characters in stories, or forces at work in our everyday lives? In this discourse, Acharya Upendra Ji explains the Trinity and their Shaktis by linking them to the three fundamental functions of life — **creation, preservation and dissolution**:

"So the three gods — we call them Brahma, Vishnu, Mahesh. And along with them, three goddesses are also spoken of."

"Always associated with Brahma is Saraswati, with Vishnu, Lakshmi, and with Mahesh, Parvati or Kali — we say Mahakal and Mahakali."

1. Beyond the Stories: What a Deity Means

Acharya Ji makes it clear that this understanding goes beyond the level of stories:

"Now we have risen far above. We don't do that storytelling; that is for children up to twelve years old."

So what does "these are goddesses, these are gods" really mean? Each deity stands for a **guna** (quality) and a **function**. Whenever we do something in life, the power of that quality is at work within us.

2. Brahma: The Rajas Shakti of Beginnings

The first function is to bring something new into being:

"If I have to create something, bring something forth, build something, then the Brahma-bhava is needed. Which is Brahma's guna? Brahma's guna is said to be rajoguna."

Rajoguna is the quality of motion, action and activity. Nothing begins without action:

"To start something, you have to take some action. You want to bring something forth, start something, launch some business — to do anything at all."

Even our own birth is the result of this power:

"For you, too, to be born, someone had to take the initiative. Whatever you want to do, what is needed at the start? Rajas Shakti — Brahma."

Every new beginning — a business, a relationship, or a life — comes from the initiative of Rajas Shakti.

3. Saraswati: Knowledge Alongside Creation

But action alone is not enough. That is why Saraswati is with Brahma:

"And along with it there must also be knowledge, which is why what is it called? Saraswati. If you create with Saraswati — with vidya, with knowledge — it will turn out better."

Acharya Ji makes a profound point — no action happens without knowledge at all. Even what we call "ignorance" is a kind of chosen knowledge:

"Something done without knowledge — there is no such concept. That ignorance — it's the absence of something. So in that way, 'I chose to have that as my knowledge.'"

The Example of Fire

"If you put your hand in fire, the hand is bound to burn. You cannot say, 'It wasn't my wish.' 'I will stay ignorant about fire' — that is the knowledge you accepted."

"Thinking 'this won't do anything,' I put it in, and then whatever the outcome, so be it."

So ignorance does not free us from responsibility:

"That kind of knowledge, which we call ignorance — meaning the absence of Saraswati — that is the level you have. Call it impure, call it less, but it is still Saraswati."

4. Everyone Has Their Own "Saraswati"

How does this show up in everyday life? Acharya Ji explains that every person keeps some argument for their actions:

"Even a thief has a reason for why he should steal."

"A lustful, adulterous person also gives a reason: 'Oh, there was Vishwamitra, and Menaka... all the others became apsaras, so what about us?'"

"The smoker, too, has an answer: 'There was Swami Samarth, or all the others, Gajanan — they too took the chillum; so we took it, smoked a cigarette.' Everybody has got their positive explanation."

"Even the drinker says, 'There's an article that a little alcohol is good as medicine' — their own benefit."

The conclusion:

"So everybody has got their own Saraswati. What level is it, how much is it? Is it your own knowledge out of ignorance, or someone else's confirmation — certified?"

And as the knowledge, so the creation:

"He will create something. He will ruin his own liver drinking and drinking — he will do something. Which knowledge you took — it is very important."

The question is not whether you have knowledge or not — it is what level that knowledge is, and whether it is verified or merely an excuse of your own making.

5. Saraswati Before Lakshmi

This place of knowledge shows up in our tradition of worship too:

"On the day of Lakshmi Puja, how many people know that Saraswati is also worshipped? Before Lakshmi Puja begins, Saraswati Puja is done. In any scripture — look even at an ordinary puja book — it is there too."

That is why Acharya Ji turns to an authentic source:

"That is why today we will read the Devi Bhagavata Purana — meaning an authentic source. Today there will be more knowledge; physical things will be very few. All actions culminate in knowledge."

This line recalls a verse of the Bhagavad Gita:

śreyān dravya-mayād yajñāj jñāna-yajñāḥ
parantapa
sarvaṁ karmākhilam pārtha jñāne
parisamāpyate

"O scorcher of foes, the sacrifice of knowledge is superior to the sacrifice of material things; O Partha, all action, in its entirety, culminates in knowledge."

— Bhagavad Gita 4.33

6. Vishnu and Lakshmi: The Power of Preservation

The second function is to sustain what has come into being:

"What is the second? Preservation. Something has been brought forth, so it has to be maintained. To maintain it you need sattvaguna. And what always comes along with it? Lakshmi."

Sattvaguna is the quality of balance, stability and purity. Acharya Ji gives the example of the body:

"Once the body is born, the body has to be maintained throughout life. So to maintain it — from food, to clothes, to its exercise — there will be some maintenance, medicines and so on. So wealth, money — Lakshmi."

The Union of Sattva and Rajas

Acharya Ji explains that in both creation and preservation, sattva and rajas work together:

"Which is Lakshmi's guna? That is rajoguna. And which guna is Vishnu's said to be? Sattvaguna. So the power of sattvaguna and rajas came in twice."

"Even while creating, there is something from sattvaguna, and then it has to be brought forth with Rajas Shakti; then, with sattvaguna and with Rajas Shakti, it has to be maintained."

In making and in sustaining alike — on one side the steady, pure sattva; on the other the active rajas. The balance of the two is what keeps life running.

7. Mahakal and Mahakali: Ending and Letting Go

The third function is inevitable — everything comes to an end one day:

"And finally, at some point there is its end — you will have to let go. Either nature will make you let go, tell you to leave, force you."

"One fine day, one clean sweep — either you have to leave the world, or the world will leave you."

This ending comes in many forms:

"Your husband will go, or there will be some relative, a business. You will go, and the business will stay as it is. Or if there is a king, the kingdom — that will go; either someone will conquer and take his kingdom, or he loses an election. Something or other happens."

"One fine day, one of the two is going to leave. Preparing for that — for that, *tamas* is needed."

Tamoguna here is the power of destruction and cessation, and it does not run by our wish:

"*Tamas* runs in auto mode, because death does not come with notice — unless one is going into *samadhi*."

"So *Kali*, and along with her *Mahadev* — *Mahakal* and *Mahakali*. That is *tamas*, *Tama-Shakti* — that destroys."

Whatever has been born will surely end. Wisdom lies in being prepared to let go, rather than having nature force us.

Summary: Key Teachings

- 1 The Trinity and their Shaktis are the three functions of life** — Brahma-Saraswati (creation), Vishnu-Lakshmi (preservation), Mahakal-Mahakali (dissolution).
- 2 Understand the deities beyond the stories** — each deity stands for a quality and a function that works within us.
- 3 Every beginning comes from Rajas Shakti** — to bring anything forth, you have to take action.
- 4 Creation needs knowledge** — creation without Saraswati is incomplete; even "ignorance" is a knowledge we chose, and its fruit comes to us.
- 5 Everyone has their own "Saraswati"** — so see what level your knowledge is, and whether it is verified or merely an excuse.
- 6 Saraswati before Lakshmi** — in worship as in life, knowledge comes before wealth.
- 7 Preservation needs sattvaguna and Lakshmi** — from the body to a business, sustaining anything needs resources.

8 The end is certain — either you leave the world, or the world leaves you; this power of tamas comes without notice, so stay prepared to let go.